Malte Kornemann

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Research Interests

Behavioral Economics, Microeconomic Theory, Cognitive Foundations of Decision-Making

Education

Ph.D. in Economics, University of Bonn	2021 – 2027 (expected)
Visiting Student, Yale University	Aug 2024 – May 2025
M.Sc. in Economic Research, University of Bonn	2021 – 2023
M.Sc. in Mathematics, University of Bonn	2019 – 2021
B.Sc. in Mathematics, University of Bonn	2016 – 2019

Job Market Paper

Errors in Aggregation and Adaptive Choice [PDF]
with Philipp Schirmer

Abstract: Most economic decisions require aggregating multiple attributes into an overall evaluation. We develop and experimentally test a theory where aggregation is error-prone and, in response, attributes are weighted optimally given an environment of likely options. We characterize these decision weights, which generically differ from attributes' impact on utility, and the bias they induce in choice. When attributes are independently distributed among likely options, higher-variance attributes are over-weighted, and this bias increases in the level of aggregation errors. We test the theory in an experiment by first manipulating between subjects which attribute varies more in choice options, and then comparing choices between options that are identical across subjects. Consistent with the model's predictions, choice probabilities shift toward the option favored by the high-variance attribute, in our baseline treatments by about 10 percentage points. We also test the effect of aggregation complexity by lowering the number of attributes. Compared to the baseline, this reduces the shift in choice probabilities by about 72%. We apply our model to purchases where base and add-on prices may be displayed separately. A consumer reacts to a short-term change in the display as if it were a price change, while her reaction to a long-run change depends on the details of the environment. Consumer welfare is generally maximized by a fully aggregated price.

Working Papers

Robustly Non-Harmful Information for Biased Learners [PDF]

Social Responsibility in Secondary Markets [PDF]
with Marc Kaufmann and Botond Kőszegi
Reject and Resubmit, *Journal of Political Economy*

Presentations

2026 North American Summer Meeting of the Econometric Society; Early-Career Behavioral Economics Conference; University of Bonn Lunch Seminar

2025 World Congress of the Econometric Society; Yale Theory Breakfast Seminar; University of Bonn Lunch Seminar

2024 4th ECONtribute YEP Workshop; 1st Bonn–Frankfurt–Mannheim Ph.D. Conference; Brown Bag Seminar Bonn

Research Positions and Fellowships

Scientific Researcher, Cluster of Excellence ECONtribute & University of Bonn — Jan 2024 – present
Research Assistant for Botond Kőszegi at IZA and briq — Oct 2023 – May 2024
Research Assistant for Thomas Graeber, Harvard Business School — Apr 2023 – Dec 2023
Doctoral Fellowship, Bonn Graduate School of Economics — 2021 – 2023

Teaching

Teaching Fellow, Applied Data Analytics for Economists, University of Bonn — Oct 2026 – Mar 2027
Teaching Assistant, Topics in Behavioral Theory, Study Center Gerzensee — Aug 2026
Teaching Assistant, Behavioral Economics, University of Bonn — Oct 2025 – Mar 2026
Teaching Fellow, Introductory Macroeconomics, Yale University — Jan 2025 – May 2025
Teaching Fellow, Intermediate Microeconomics, Yale University — Aug 2024 – Dec 2024

Other Information

Refereeing: *Journal of the European Economic Association*
Summer School Participation: RSF Summer Institute in Behavioral Economics — 2026

Personal

Citizenship: German
Languages: German (native), English (fluent)

References

Botond Kőszegi (Primary Advisor)
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Thomas Graeber
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